

# JULIAN LEE-SURSIN

*Curriculum Vitae — April 2026*

✉ jleesur1@jh.edu

🌐 julianleesursin.com

AREAS OF SPECIALIZATION: Language, Cognitive Science

AREAS OF COMPETENCE: Philosophy of Science, Philosophy of Mind, Metaphysics, Fashion

## APPOINTMENT

---

**Visiting Scholar** (*chercheur invité*), JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY 2025–2026

## EDUCATION

---

ÉCOLE NORMALE SUPÉRIEURE, **MS** in Cognitive Science 2024–present  
17/20 GPA (first year)<sup>1</sup>

JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY, Visiting Graduate Student 2025–2026

SORBONNE UNIVERSITÉ, **MPhil**, Philosophy of science, knowledge, and mind 2023–2025  
*Mention très bien* (highest honors)

OBERLIN COLLEGE, **BA**, Honors in Philosophy 2020–2023

## PAPERS (SELECTED)

---

### MANUSCRIPT

- **Subject-Dependence in Science: The Argument from Complementarity** (under review)  
with HONG JOO RYOO
- **Panpsychism and the Individuation Problem: Comments on Taofeek** (under review)
- **Is Acquaintance a *Sui Generis* Epistemic Relation?**  
Manuscript, Winner of the 2025 Graduate Paper Prize, Indiana Philosophical Association

### IN PROGRESS (Drafts available upon request)

- A Paper on Why-Questions
- A Paper on Autonomous Self-Correction in AI Agents (with HONG JOO RYOO)
- A Paper on Perceptual Content in Fashion
- A Paper on Composition and Metalinguistic Negotiation

## PRESENTATIONS

\* = abstract refereed    \*\* = paper refereed    † = invited

22. **Presentism Precludes Explanation** (\*\*) Aug 24-28, 2026  
12th European Congress of Analytic Philosophy, Madrid, Spain

---

<sup>1</sup>Grades in France are assigned on a scale from 0–20: 10 is passing, 12 awards honors (*mention assez bien*), 14 awards high honors (*mention bien*), and 16 awards highest honors (*mention très bien*).

21. **Curb Your (Brain-Model Alignment) Enthusiasm (\*)** Aug 24-28, 2026  
Co-authored with Arnold Fleishman  
12th European Congress of Analytic Philosophy, Madrid, Spain
20. **A Semantic Argument Against Radical Cognitivism (\*\*)** Jul 8-10, 2026  
100th Joint Session of the Aristotelian and Mind Societies, Reading, UK
19. **An Explanatory Cognitive Model for Blackwell Informativeness (\*)** June 17-19, 2026  
10th International Conference on Model-Based Reasoning, Rome, Italy
18. **Answering Why-Questions (\*)** June 12-14, 2026  
Swedish Congress of Philosophy, Stockholm, Sweden
17. **On Fashion's Perceptual Content (\*\*)** June 8-10, 2026  
European Society for Aesthetics, Jyväskylä, Finland
16. **Do AI Agents Meet the Epistemic Norms for Explanation? (\*)** Apr 25, 2026  
Inaugural Humanities of AI Workshop, JHU, Baltimore, MD
15. **On Fashion's Perceptual Meaning (\*\*)** Apr 10, 2026  
American Society for Aesthetics, Eastern Division, Philadelphia, PA
14. **On Why-Questions (†)** April 9, 2026  
Semantics Lab, Department of Cognitive Science, JHU, Baltimore, MD
13. **A Semantic Argument Against Radical Cognitivism (\*\*)** April 4, 2026  
UF Graduate Philosophy Conference, Gainesville, FL
12. **Why Presentism Precludes Explanation (\*)** Feb 18, 2026  
Central APA, Philosophy of Time Society, Chicago, IL
11. **How Causation Explains: A Semantic Inquiry (\*)** Jan 7, 2026  
Eastern APA, Society for Philosophy of Causation, Baltimore, MD
10. **Fashion and the Jacksonian Mode: Intentionality Beyond Language (\*\*)** Nov 20, 2025  
Symposium, Institut Français de la Mode, Paris, France
9. **Semantics for Explanation (\*\*)** Nov 8, 2025  
Illinois Philosophical Association, Charleston, IL
8. **Composition and Metalinguistic Negotiation (†)** Nov 3, 2025  
Talk for philosophy majors and faculty, Oberlin College
7. **Is Acquaintance a Sui Generis Epistemic Relation? (\*\*)** Nov 1, 2025  
Indiana Philosophical Association, Bloomington, IN
6. **Semantics for Explanation (\*\*)** Oct 24, 2025  
24th University of Toronto Grad Conference, Toronto, Canada
5. **Is Acquaintance a Sui Generis Epistemic Relation? (\*)** Oct 16, 2025  
CREPH: Mind Conference, Liège, Belgium
4. **Do AI Agents Meet the Epistemic Norms for Explanation? (\*)** Oct 9, 2025  
XVI International Ontology Congress, Basque Country
3. **The Special Questions Dispute (\*\*)** Sep 5, 2025  
SOPhiA, Salzburg, Austria

- |                                                                              |              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 2. <b>The Special Questions Dispute</b> (**)                                 | Jul 13, 2025 |
| 99th Joint Session of the Aristotelian and Mind Societies, Glasgow, Scotland |              |
| 1. <b>Composition and Metalinguistic Negotiation</b> (†)                     | May 9, 2025  |
| Salvador Mascarenhas Lab Meeting, Institut Jean Nicod, Paris, France         |              |

## COMMENTS

- Jon Joey Telebrico: “Epistemic Debt and Responsibility: Preserving Knowledge in an Age of LLMs”  
Inaugural Humanities of AI Workshop, JHU, Baltimore, MD Apr 25, 2026
- Adekunle Taofeek: “The Individuation Problem for Plant Souls in Panpsychist Ontology”  
Southwest Philosophical Society, Savannah, GA Nov 22, 2025
- Patrick Skeels: “There can be no Dispute”  
Illinois Philosophical Association, Charleston, IL Nov 8, 2025

## FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

---

- |                                                                                      |           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 9. <b>Research Fellowship</b> , Johns Hopkins University (\$12,000)                  | 2025–2026 |
| Fellowship stipend to conduct research as a Visiting Scholar                         |           |
| 8. <b>Tuition Subsidy</b> , Johns Hopkins University (\$66,670)                      | 2025–2026 |
| Full subsidy to take any course(s) as a visiting graduate student                    |           |
| 7. <b>Honorarium</b> , Institut Français de la Mode (€1,600)                         | Nov 2025  |
| Award for presentation at the Fashion and Language Symposium                         |           |
| 6. <b>Graduate Paper Prize</b> (\$100)                                               | Oct 2025  |
| Best paper by graduate student, Indiana Philosophical Association                    |           |
| 5. <b>Bursary</b> , CREPH ARC research project: MIND (€500)                          | Aug 2025  |
| Funding for presentation at the University of Liège                                  |           |
| 4. <b>Travel Grant</b> , Sorbonne Philosophy Department (€500)                       | May 2025  |
| Funding for AS/Mind Joint Session presentation                                       |           |
| 3. <b>Paul W. Wurzbürger Prize in French</b> (\$1,000)                               | May 2023  |
| Concours de la Maison Française de Cleveland, affiliated with the Alliance Française |           |
| 2. <b>Prix Lahaurine-Johnston</b> (\$1,000)                                          | May 2022  |
| Annual prize for investment in Oberlin’s Maison Française                            |           |
| 1. <b>John F. Oberlin Merit Scholarship</b> (\$30,000 total)                         | 2020–2023 |
| Merit scholarship, renewed for all three years I was at Oberlin                      |           |

## TEACHING

---

|                 |           |
|-----------------|-----------|
| OBERLIN COLLEGE | 2021–2023 |
|-----------------|-----------|

- Sole Grader and Tutor, Deductive Logic
- Tutor: Philosophy, French, Math, CS, Latin, Econ
- Sole Resident Assistant, Maison Française (2022–2023)
- TA (weekly session as sole instructor), Intermediate French (Spring 2021)

|                                                 |             |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| US MILITARY / ROCHESTER INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY | Summer 2021 |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------|

- Sole instructor: Robotics, CS, and Biochem courses for the Army Educational Outreach Program

## EMPIRICAL RESEARCH

---

MICHIGAN STATE UNIVERSITY, Arnosti Lab Summer 2019

- Investigated modified retinoblastoma (Rbf) gene in *Drosophila* using dCas9 chimeras

FLORIDA STATE UNIVERSITY, Arbeitman Lab Summer 2018

- Tasked with CRISPR & U6-gRNA cloning, *Drosophila* cortex dissection, and gel electrophoresis

NATIONAL HIGH MAGNETIC FIELD LABORATORY, Condensed Matter Lab 2015–2017  
(under the supervision of JOHAN VAN TOL)

- Designed a millimeter wave resonator. When measuring polymers (e.g., polystyrene), intensity increased by a factor of 8, pulselengths decreased by a factor of 3–4 (compared to measurements without the resonator).
- Built miniature solar-powered vehicle using CAD and soldering

## SERVICE & AFFILIATIONS

---

**Member:** American Philosophical Association, American Society for Aesthetics, Aristotelian Society, European Society for Aesthetics, Philosophy of Time Society, Society for Philosophy of Causation, South-western Philosophical Society

**Board Member:** Youth Advisory Board, National High Magnetic Field Laboratory (2021–2023)

**Editor:** *The Synapse: Intercollegiate science magazine* (2021–2022)

## VARIA

---

**Fashion:** Performed in Paris Fashion Week (*Duranimal*) and the Saut Hermès Dinner Mar 2025

**Music:** I sing bass, currently studying at Peabody Preparatory. Notable concerts below:

- |                                                                      |          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| • Verdi's <i>Macbeth</i> with Plácido Domingo (Salle Gaveau)         | Apr 2025 |
| • Rossini's <i>Le Comte Ory</i> (Théâtre des Champs-Élysées)         | Nov 2024 |
| • Bastille Day Parade (ft. Macron and the Olympic torch)             | Jul 2024 |
| • Royal Philharmonic Orchestra, dir. Joe Hisaishi (La Défense Arena) | Apr 2024 |
| • Mozart's Mass in C minor at Les Invalides                          | Dec 2023 |
| • Regular concerts at the Philharmonie de Paris                      |          |

## GRADUATE COURSEWORK

---

- **Johns Hopkins University**<sup>2</sup>
  - Advanced Topics in Philosophy of Mind and Cognitive Science (Spring 2026, EJ Green/Mason Westfall)
  - Puzzles about Belief (Fall 2025, Jeremy Goodman)
  - Truth-makers and Mental Models (Fall 2025, Justin Bledin)
- **École Normale Supérieure**<sup>3</sup>
  - Semantics (Spring 2025, Salvador Mascarenhas)
  - Language (Fall 2024, Salvador Mascarenhas)
  - Representational Foundations of Mind (Fall 2024, Denis Buehler)
- **Sorbonne Université**<sup>4</sup>
  - Philosophy of Techniques and Technology (Spring 2025, Anouk Barberousse)
  - Philosophy of Mathematics (Spring 2025, Olivier Rey)
  - Philosophy of Science in English IV (Spring 2025, Cécilia Bognon-Küss)
  - Metaphysics of Science (Fall 2024, Max Kistler)
  - Philosophy of Economics (Fall 2024, Cédric Paternotte)
  - Philosophy of Science in English III (Fall 2024, Anouk Barberousse)
  - Epistemology and Metaphysics (Spring 2024, Jean-Baptiste Rauzy)
  - Philosophy of Mind/Cognitive Science (Spring 2024, Pascal Ludwig)
  - The Implicit (Élise Marrou)
  - Advanced Logic (Spring 2024, Pascal Ludwig)
  - Philosophy of Science in English II (Spring 2024, Cédric Paternotte)
  - Authenticity (Existentialism) (Spring 2024, Claude Romano)
  - Scientific Reasoning (Fall 2023, Isabelle Drouet)
  - Philosophy of Biology (Fall 2023, Cédric Paternotte)
  - Philosophy of Physics (Fall 2023, Vincent Ardourel)
  - Intro to Logic (Fall 2023, Isabelle Drouet)
  - Philosophy of Science in English I (Fall 2023, Rayan Geha)
  - Husserlian Phenomenology (Fall 2023, Dominique Pradelle)

## REFERENCES

Available upon request

---

<sup>2</sup>As a visiting graduate student, courses at JHU are audited.

<sup>3</sup>Listed ENS courses were taught in English.

<sup>4</sup>Courses at Sorbonne Université were taught in French (titles translated by me), except ‘Philosophy of Science in English’ I-IV.